

## SCENE I: Childhood

**Setting:** Filipino neighborhood in Tagaytay. A large tree dominates stage right, with branches extending over part of the stage. Minimal festival props (portable decorations, coconut shells, slippers) are scattered downstage.

**Lighting:** Warm golden-hour hues (amber/yellow) to suggest late afternoon

### Key Directions:

- Opening: Kids play games center stage
  - Tree Moment: When Carlos and AJ sit under the tree, lighting dims slightly to focus on them
  - Maglalatik Rehearsal:
    - Audio: Drumbeat starts as Mr. Concepcion speaks. Coconut shells clack rhythmically during practice.
    - Lighting: Brighter, more focused (white light) during the dance.
  - Maglalatik Performance:
    - Music plays immediately after this line is repeated 4x by Carlos and AJ in the stage play:  
“Knees, chest, back, hips, knees, chest, back, hips...”
    - Dancers will enter from both sides of the stage, while Carlos and AJ exit off stage
  - Pinky Promise: Soft spotlight on their hands carving the tree.
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## SCENE II: High School

**Setting:** School garden with a bench. Flower baskets and scattered petals (from bulaklakan prep) downstage.

**Lighting:** Bright daylight (cool white with hints of pink/blue for floral ambiance).

### **Key Directions:**

- Bulaklakan Prep: Benji's flower spill should be dramatic (petals fly).
  - Carlos/AJ Moment:
    - Lighting: Warms (amber) as others exit, leaving them alone.
    - Audio: School bell chimes when Isabella interrupts.
  - Exit: Friends whisper loudly for comedic effect; Reyna and Lena's bet should be audible to the audience.
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## SCENE III: University

**Setting:** College party. Streamers, makeshift bar, dance floor center stage.

**Lighting:** Dynamic party lights (multicolored, flashing during high-energy scenes). Slow dance: dim blue spotlight on Carlos/AJ.

**Audio:**

- Party: Upbeat OPM or modern pop.
- Slow Dance: Transition to a soft Filipino love song (Umaasa instrumental).

**Key Directions:**

- Curtain is closed for the LETTER, then opens after it is read
  - Slow Dance: Other couples blur into darkness; only Carlos/AJ are lit.
  - Interruption: Isabella's entrance is abrupt—audio cuts to silence.
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## SCENE IV: Missed Confession

**Setting:** Home (dining table, couch) transitions to park (bench, tree).

**Lighting:**

- Home: Warm, dim (evening). Harsh clinical light when Mario mentions the hospital.
- Park: Twilight (deep blue/purple with faint moonlight).

**Key Directions:**

- Mario's News: Lights flicker (subtle) during the tumor reveal.
  - Airport Goodbye: Friends enter with boxes—audio of airplane engine faintly builds.
  - Near-Confession: Lights almost fade to black, interrupted by phone ring (sharp sound cue).
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## SCENE V: America

**Setting:** Chicago apartment (window with "snow," small dining area).

**Lighting:** Cold blue (window) contrasting warm amber (inside).

**Audio:** Wind howling, faint Filipino radio (e.g., MAP playing in the background).

**Key Directions:**

- Lullaby: Mario's voice fades first, then Isabella/Carlos continue a cappella.
  - Flashback: Projected images of the Philippines during the song.
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## SCENE VI: Nurse(ry)

**Setting:** Hospital (rolling carts, clipboard, baby blanket).

**Lighting:** Harsh fluorescent (bright white) softening to warm during the baby scene.

**Audio:** Hospital PA announcements, beeping monitors.

**Key Directions:**

- Baby Moment: Spotlight on Carlos; other actors freeze.
  - Audio: Faint MAPA lullaby as he speaks to the baby.
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## SCENE VII: Letters

**Setting:** Sitting down at a table with a bench.

**Lighting:** Center spotlight on the people that are reading the letters.

**Key Directions:**

- Curtain is closed during each letter
- AJ will be reading the letters center stage, with the rest of the barkada near him only for the first one.
- For the first letter, the barkada will walk into the spotlight when they say their lines

## SCENE VIII: Pamana

**Setting:** Tree returns (now with carved initials). Projected dates (2001, 2006) for letters.

**Lighting:** Sunrise hues (pink/orange) for homecoming.

**Key Directions:**

- Reunion: AJ's entrance is lit suddenly (bright spotlight).
- Final Speech: Ensemble gathers under the tree; lights warm as Carlos speaks.